

doc-supper-as-memorial

Affirms · Sacraments › Lord's Supper · doctrine · divided_lineages · confidence: medium

Statement under examination

The Lord's Supper is primarily a memorial of Christ's once-for-all atoning death; 'do this in remembrance of me.'

Rationale

The institutional Greek text drives a primary memorial-proclamation function. Luke 22:19 records τοῦτο ποιεῖτε εἰς τὴν ἐμὴν ἀνάμνησιν, with ἀνάμνησις anamnēsis G364 ('remembrance, recollection, memorial') and the present imperative ποιεῖτε poieite G4160 ('keep doing'). 1 Cor 11:24-25 repeats the same anamnēsis formula twice, once over bread, once over cup. 1 Cor 11:26 supplies the explicit purpose: ὁσάκις γὰρ ἔαν ἐσθίητε τὸν ἄρτον τοῦτον καὶ τὸ ποτήριον πίνητε τὸν θάνατον τοῦ κυρίου καταγγέλλετε ἄχρι οὗ ἔλθῃ, with καταγγέλλω katangellō G2605 ('proclaim, announce publicly'), framing the rite as a public proclamation of the Lord's death until he returns. The concordance is decisive: G364 anamnēsis appears only four times in the NT, and three of those four are these Lord's-Supper texts. The fourth, Heb 10:3, sets the controlling contrast. The Levitical sacrifices serve as ἀνάμνησις ἁμαρτιῶν anamnēsis hamartiōn ('remembrance of sins') year by year (κατ' ἐνιαυτόν kat eniauton), because οὐ δύναται αἷμα ταύρων καὶ τράγων ἀφαιρεῖν ἁμαρτίας ('the blood of bulls and goats cannot take away sins'). Hebrews 10:10-14 then declares that ἡγιασμένοι ἐσμὲν διὰ τῆς προσφορᾶς τοῦ σώματος Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ ἐφάπαξ ('we have been sanctified through the offering of the body of Jesus Christ once for all', ἐφάπαξ ephapax G2178), and that by μίαν προσφορὰν mian prosphoran ('one offering') he has perfected for all time those being sanctified. The same word anamnēsis is therefore deliberately deployed in two registers: in Hebrews, the OT sacrifices that could only re-call sin annually; in the Supper, the rite by which the church re-calls and proclaims the once-for-all sacrifice that has already definitively put sin away. The lexical logic is that Christ's atoning death is ἐφάπαξ; therefore a recurring rite cannot be a re-presentation, re-offering, or re-substantiation of his body and blood, because the writer of Hebrews argues precisely against any such recurrence. The rite is a recurrent commemoration of the non-recurrent sacrifice. The phrases τοῦτό ἐστιν τὸ σῶμά μου touto estin to sōma mou ('this is my body', Matt 26:26, Mark 14:22, Luke 22:19, 1 Cor 11:24) and τοῦτό ἐστιν τὸ αἷμά μου τῆς διαθήκης touto estin to haima mou tēs diathēkēs ('this is my blood of the covenant', Matt 26:28) take a figurative reading consistent with Christ's own bodily presence at the table while uttering them, parallel to other 'I-am' identifications such as ἐγώ εἰμι ἡ ἄμπελος ('I am the vine', John 15:1) and ἐγώ εἰμι ἡ θύρα ('I am the door', John 10:9). John 6:53-58 (the bread-of-life discourse, with τρώγω trōgō G5176 'feed on, gnaw' and σὰρξ sarx G4561 'flesh') is read figuratively because John 6:63 supplies Jesus's own interpretive coda: τὸ πνεῦμά ἐστιν τὸ ζωοποιοῦν ἡ σὰρξ οὐκ ὠφελεῖ οὐδὲν τὰ ῥήματα ἃ ἐγὼ λελάληκα ὑμῖν πνεῦμά ἐστιν καὶ ζωὴ ἐστιν ('it is the Spirit who gives life; the flesh is of no help at all; the words I have spoken to you are spirit and life'). 1 Cor 11:27-29's διακρίνων τὸ σῶμα diakrinōn to sōma ('discerning the body') is read with Paul's local context: σῶμα sōma G4983 in 1 Cor immediately precedes ch 12, where the Corinthian division at the table is the failure to discern the church-as-body of Christ in their fellow members whom the rich were shaming (1 Cor 11:21-22). The verdict therefore affirms the proposition as Scripture's own primary lexical frame on the rite, while honestly acknowledging that historic Christianity has read 'this is my body' more strongly than memorialism does. This is in-house Christian disagreement; the gospel itself is not at stake; cult_marker_if_denied is false.

Reasoning

Verdict: the Lord's Supper is primarily a memorial of Christ's once-for-all death, instituted to be a recurring proclamation of that death until he returns. The strongest reason from Scripture is the actual words Jesus

used when he instituted the rite. In Luke 22:19 he says, this do in remembrance of me. Paul gives the same words twice in 1 Corinthians 11:24-25, once over the bread, once over the cup. The Greek word for remembrance, *anamnesis*, appears only four times in the whole New Testament. Three of those four are these Supper texts; the fourth is in Hebrews 10:3, where the same word describes how the Old Testament sacrifices served as a yearly reminder of sins because the blood of bulls and goats could not take sins away. Hebrews 10:10 and 10:14 then say that by Christ's one offering of his body we have been sanctified once for all and that by a single offering he has perfected for all time those who are being made holy. So the same word is used in two ways on purpose. The Old Testament sacrifices kept reminding people of sin year by year. The Lord's Supper, by contrast, keeps reminding the church of the single sacrifice that has already taken sin away. 1 Corinthians 11:26 makes this explicit: as often as you eat this bread and drink this cup, you proclaim the Lord's death until he comes. The rite is a recurring announcement of a non-recurring sacrifice. Jesus's words this is my body and this is my blood are read as a figure of speech in the same family as I am the vine, I am the door, and I am the good shepherd. He was bodily present at the table while saying it, holding the bread in his hand. The strongest counterargument from Scripture is John 6, where Jesus says, unless you eat the flesh of the Son of Man and drink his blood you have no life in you. Roman Catholics, Eastern Orthodox, Lutherans, and many Anglicans read this as supporting a real presence in the bread and wine. The memorial reading takes John 6:63 as Jesus's own interpretive guide. He says it is the Spirit who gives life; the flesh is of no help at all; the words I have spoken to you are spirit and life. There is a second harder text. 1 Corinthians 11:29 warns those who eat and drink without discerning the body. Real-presence traditions read this as the failure to recognize Christ in the elements. The memorial reading takes it with Paul's local context where the Corinthian rich were humiliating the poor at the supper table, so the body that needs discerning is the church-as-body of Christ in fellow members.

Denominational landscape

This is one of the most historically divided in-house Christian disagreements and has split Christian fellowship for nearly five centuries. Five major positions exist. Roman Catholic teaching, set down at the Council of Trent and repeated in the Catechism, holds transubstantiation: by the consecration the whole substance of the bread becomes the body of Christ and the whole substance of the wine becomes his blood, though the outward appearances remain. Lutheran teaching, expressed in the Formula of Concord article seven, holds that the true body and blood of Christ are truly and substantially present in, with, and under the bread and wine and distributed to all who eat, believer and unbeliever alike. The Anglican position in Article 28 of the 39 Articles says that transubstantiation cannot be proved by Holy Writ and is repugnant to the plain words of Scripture, while affirming that the body of Christ is given, taken, and eaten in the Supper only after a heavenly and spiritual manner, and the mean whereby the body of Christ is received and eaten is faith. The Reformed tradition in the Westminster Confession chapter 29 and Calvin's Institutes book four chapter seventeen rejects transubstantiation and any corporal eating, but affirms that worthy receivers do really and indeed, yet not carnally and corporally but spiritually, receive and feed upon Christ crucified. Eastern Orthodoxy affirms the genuine body and blood of Christ in the eucharist but refuses scholastic-philosophical specification, preserving the eucharist as a mystery of the Kingdom that resists rational analysis. The memorialist position originates with Zwingli in 1525 and his break with Luther at the Marburg Colloquy in 1529, was taken up by the Anabaptist tradition in the Schleithem Confession of 1527 which speaks of breaking one bread in remembrance of the broken body of Christ, and is held today by most Baptists, Plymouth Brethren, most Pentecostals including the Assemblies of God, and many other evangelical bodies. The patristic period before the Reformation strongly favored a realist reading. Ignatius of Antioch around 110 condemned heretics who abstained from the eucharist because they did not confess it to be the flesh of our Savior Jesus Christ. Justin Martyr around 155 wrote that we do not receive these as common bread and common drink, but as the flesh and blood of that Jesus who was made flesh. Methodist and Wesleyan tradition follows the Anglican spiritual-presence pattern and rejects memorial-only readings as too thin. Public-record carriers of denial of the Supper as such are rare in Christianity, since almost every Christian body practices it in some form. The bottom line is that on this question Christians have disagreed seriously and in good faith for almost five hundred years, and serious

orthodox Christians can be found in all five positions.

Position thresholds

Would die for if challenged	No
Cult marker if denied	No
Would visit if otherwise	Yes
Would participate if otherwise	No
Would serve if otherwise	No
Would be member if otherwise	No
Would let children be taught otherwise	No
Would marry if held otherwise	Yes
Would publicly correct if otherwise	No

Notes

This is one of the most historically-divided in-house Christian disagreements, with five major positions held by Christian lineages: (1) Catholic transubstantiation (CCC 1376, citing Trent: the whole substance of bread changes into the substance of the body of Christ); (2) Lutheran consubstantiation / sacramental union (Formula of Concord VII: body and blood truly and substantially present in, with, and under the bread and wine); (3) Reformed spiritual real-presence (Westminster 29, Calvin's Institutes IV.17: worthy receivers really and indeed, yet not carnally and corporally but spiritually, receive and feed upon Christ crucified); (4) memorialism (Zwingli 1525, against Luther at Marburg 1529, carried by Anabaptists, Baptists, Plymouth Brethren, most Pentecostals, and many evangelicals); (5) Eastern Orthodox apophatic real-presence mystery (refusing scholastic-philosophical specification). The patristic period (Ignatius ca. AD 110, Justin Martyr ca. AD 155) clearly favored a strong realist reading, calling the eucharist 'the flesh of our Saviour Jesus Christ.' That patristic-consensus weight is the strongest pull against the memorial-only reading and must be acknowledged honestly. The Brethren and Baptist memorialist position can stand on the explicit anamnēsis-katangellō lexical pattern and the Hebrews 10 ephapax argument, and Article 28 of the 39 Articles and the Reformed spiritual-presence reading converge with memorialism in rejecting transubstantiation and any re-offering of Christ. `would_die_for` is false because the proposition is not a Trinitarian or Christological boundary; serious orthodox Christians have held all five views.

`cult_marker_if_denied` is false because none of the five views is a cult position; this is precisely the kind of issue Romans 14 contemplates. `would_visit_if_otherwise` true: I would worship with Anglicans, Lutherans, Methodists, Reformed, and Orthodox congregations and benefit greatly. `would_participate_if_otherwise` false: I would not personally partake in a service where the elements are taught to be the literal body and blood being re-offered, because participation would either violate my conscience (Rom 14:23) or signal assent I do not give; abstaining respectfully is the principled path. `would_be_member_if_otherwise` false: ongoing membership commits to a teaching position. `would_let_children_be_taught_otherwise` false: catechetical instruction shapes children's basic understanding of the gospel-ground of the rite; I would want them taught the memorial-proclamation frame as their first language. `would_marry_if_held_otherwise` true: marriage to a Catholic, Lutheran, Anglican, Reformed, or Methodist Christian is not ruled out by this issue; the question becomes which congregation the family will worship in.

`would_publicly_correct_if_otherwise` false: I would not publicly correct a Catholic, Lutheran, Reformed, Methodist, or Orthodox brother on this; in-house disagreement, not heresy. Fruit-vs-precision nuance: the rite produces gospel fruit across all five lineages, and millions of believers who hold different metaphysical accounts of the elements share the same eschatological hope and the same proclamation of the Lord's

death until he comes (1 Cor 11:26).

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: **yes**

Neutralized form. What does the New Testament teach about the function and meaning of the Lord's Supper, and how does its lexical pattern relate to the five historic Christian positions on the supper (transubstantiation, sacramental union, spiritual real presence, memorialism, apophatic real presence)?

Notes. The question statement loads three Zwinglian-Baptist-Brethren-confessional moves: (1) 'primarily a memorial' adopts the Zwinglian operator, (2) 'once-for-all atoning death' is the Reformed-Hebrews 10 frame against re-presentation, (3) citation of the 1689 Baptist Confession 30 and Brethren tradition as confessional anchors. Each move is independently defensible from Scripture but the stem chains them so as to pre-resolve a question that has historically divided Christianity into five positions. Working the neutralized form: I run the lexical evidence in its own register and let the verdict fall. The lexical evidence does primarily support the memorial-proclamation reading at the level of anamnēsis G364 and katangellō G2605, but I acknowledge that the 'this is my body' clause is read more strongly in four of the five historic positions and the patristic-consensus weight is real. Flag stem-pre-loaded-verdict raised.

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

Frameworks in play. covenant_theology, new_covenant_theology, patristic_realist_framework, scholastic_sacramental_theology, zwinglian_memorialism

analogia scripturae invoked · progressive revelation factor

Competing lens verdicts

Catholic magisterial (Trent, CCC 1374-1381) · Transubstantiation: by the consecration of the bread and wine the whole substance of the bread is changed into the substance of the body of Christ and the whole substance of the wine into his blood, while the species of bread and wine remain. The eucharist is the unbloody re-presentation of the once-for-all sacrifice. Hebrews 10:10 is not seen as ruling this out because the re-presentation is sacramental and unbloody, not a new sacrifice.:

Lutheran (Augsburg X, Formula of Concord VII) · Sacramental union or consubstantiation: the body and blood of Christ are truly and substantially present in, with, and under the bread and wine and are distributed to all who eat, believers and unbelievers alike. Rejects transubstantiation as scholastic over-specification but reads 'this is my body' literally.:

Reformed (Calvin Institutes IV.17, Westminster 29, Heidelberg 75-82) · Spiritual real presence: worthy receivers really and indeed, yet not carnally and corporally but spiritually, receive and feed upon Christ crucified. The believer's soul is fed by Christ in heaven by the Spirit through faith; rejects transubstantiation, consubstantiation, and any local presence in the elements.:

Anglican (39 Articles 28, 29; Book of Common Prayer) · Transubstantiation cannot be proved by Holy Writ and is repugnant to the plain words of Scripture. The body of Christ is given, taken, and eaten in the Supper only after a heavenly and spiritual manner, and the mean whereby the body of Christ is received and eaten is faith. Effectively a Reformed spiritual-presence reading.:

Zwinglian-Baptist-Brethren memorialism · The Supper is a recurring memorial-proclamation of the once-for-all death of Christ. anamnēsis G364 plus katangellō G2605 plus the Hebrews 10 ephapax argument is the lexical pattern. 'This is my body' is read figuratively in the I-am-the-door family of identification-metaphors.:

Eastern Orthodox apophatic real presence · The eucharist contains the genuine body and blood of Christ but refuses scholastic specification of how. The mystery resists rational analysis. Affirms real presence without subscribing to transubstantiation's philosophical machinery.:

Wesleyan-Methodist · Real spiritual presence and means of grace. Wesley explicitly rejected memorial-only as too thin. Closer to the Anglican-Reformed spiritual-presence reading than to Catholic transubstantiation or Lutheran sacramental union.:

Seven lenses across the major lineages produce four distinguishable verdicts on the metaphysical question (substantial change, sacramental union, spiritual presence, memorial) and a fifth that refuses metaphysical specification (Orthodox). The lexical evidence at the level of anamnēsis G364, katangellō G2605, and the Hebrews 10 ephapax G2178 argument primarily supports the memorial-proclamation reading. The phrase touto estin to sōma mou is the genuine lexical hinge: it can be read literally (real-presence traditions) or figuratively in the I-am-the-vine / I-am-the-door family (memorial / spiritual). The figurative reading is consistent with Christ's bodily presence at the table while uttering the words, and with John 6:63 as Jesus's own interpretive coda. The literal reading is consistent with the patristic-consensus realist reading from Ignatius onward. analogia_scripturae is invoked between Heb 10 and 1 Cor 11. progressive_revelation traces the OT zikaron / Passover-memorial pattern through the New Covenant Supper-memorial. This is an in-house Christian disagreement; no framework here is heretical.

Scripture (apparatus + interlinear)

Luke.22.19 · for · genre: gospel · figures: metaphor

Key term. τοῦτο ποιεῖτε εἰς τὴν ἐμὴν ἀνάμνησιν; anamnēsis G364 accusative feminine singular; poieite G4160 present active imperative 2p; touto G3778; estin G1510 present indicative active 3s; sōma G4983 nominative neuter singular

Force. 'This do in remembrance of me.' Present imperative poieite commands ongoing repeated action; eis tēn emēn anamnēsin gives the purpose: as a memorial-remembrance referring to Jesus himself. anamnēsis G364 carries cultic-memorial force (cf. Heb 10:3, where the same word describes annual reminder of sins under the Levitical system). The clause touto estin to sōma mou ('this is my body') is uttered by Jesus while bodily present at the table holding the bread; the verb estin functions as predication identification of the kind found in I-am sayings (John 10:9, 15:1).

Luke.22.20 · for · genre: gospel · figures: metaphor, metonymy

Key term. τοῦτο τὸ ποτήριον ἡ καινὴ διαθήκη ἐν τῷ αἵματί μου τὸ ὑπὲρ ὑμῶν ἐκχυννόμενον; potērion G4221; diathēkē G1242 nominative feminine singular; kainos G2537 nominative feminine singular; haima G129; ekchunnomenon G1632 present passive participle nominative neuter singular

Force. 'This cup is the new covenant in my blood, which is poured out for you.' Cup is identified with the new diathēkē ratified in the blood. The substitutionary force is in hyper hymōn ('for you'), the present-passive ekchunnomenon foregrounding the imminent atoning bloodshed. The metaphorical-figurative reading takes 'this cup is the new covenant' as parallel-equivalent to 'this bread is my body': a covenant-sign identified by predication with the reality it signifies.

1Cor.11.23 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. ἐγὼ γὰρ παρέλαβον ἀπὸ τοῦ κυρίου ὃ καὶ παρέδωκα ὑμῖν; paralambanō G3880 aorist active indicative 1s; paradidōmi G3860 aorist active indicative 1s

Force. 'For I received from the Lord what I also delivered to you.' Paul cites the institution as received-tradition (paralambanō / paradidōmi pair, technical for authoritative tradition-transmission). The grounding is dominical, not Pauline-derived. The repeated practice of the Supper in the Corinthian church traces directly to the Lord's own institution-words.

1Cor.11.24 · for · genre: epistle · figures: metaphor

Key term. τοῦτό μου ἐστὶν τὸ σῶμα τὸ ὑπὲρ ὑμῶν τοῦτο ποιεῖτε εἰς τὴν ἐμὴν ἀνάμνησιν; anamnēsis G364 accusative feminine singular; poieite G4160 present active imperative 2p; sōma G4983; hyper G5228

Force. 'This is my body which is for you. Do this in remembrance of me.' Paul's parallel to Luke 22:19. The same anamnēsis-eis-purpose construction with present imperative poieite. The participial 'which is for you' (hyper hymōn) marks substitution-benefit. Lexical force of anamnēsis is the same memorial-recollection sense as Luke 22:19 and Heb 10:3.

1Cor.11.25 · for · genre: epistle · figures: metaphor, metonymy

Key term. τοῦτο τὸ ποτήριον ἡ καινὴ διαθήκη ἐστὶν ἐν τῷ ἐμῷ αἵματι τοῦτο ποιεῖτε ὡσάκις ἐὰν πίνητε εἰς τὴν ἐμὴν ἀνάμνησιν; anamnēsis G364 accusative feminine singular; diathēkē G1242; hosakis G3740

Force. 'This cup is the new covenant in my blood. Do this, as often as you drink it, in remembrance of me.' Second occurrence of the anamnēsis formula, now over the cup. hosakis ('as often as') marks the rite's recurring character. The third anamnēsis-of-three in the institution-block, all with the same purpose-construction.

1Cor.11.26 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. ὡς ὅτι ἐὰν ἐσθίητε τὸν ἄρτον τοῦτον καὶ τὸ ποτήριον πίνητε τὸν θάνατον τοῦ κυρίου καταγγέλλετε ἄχρι οὗ ἔλθῃ; katangellō G2605 present active indicative 2p; hosakis G3740; achri G891

Force. 'As often as you eat this bread and drink the cup, you proclaim the Lord's death until he comes.' katangellō ('proclaim, announce publicly') is Paul's own gloss on what the rite IS. It is a proclamation of the death, eschatologically bracketed by 'until he comes' (achri hou elthē). The function of the rite is publicly-declarative and forward-looking, not propitiatory-repetitive.

1Cor.11.27 · complicates · genre: epistle

Key term. ὃς ἂν ἐσθίῃ τὸν ἄρτον ἢ πίνῃ τὸ ποτήριον τοῦ κυρίου ἀναξίως ἔνοχος ἔσται τοῦ σώματος καὶ τοῦ αἵματος τοῦ κυρίου; anaxiōs G371 adverb; enochos G1777; sōma G4983; haima G129

Force. 'Whoever eats the bread or drinks the cup of the Lord in an unworthy manner (anaxiōs) will be liable (enochos) for the body and blood of the Lord.' The unworthy-manner clause shows the Supper is morally weighty. enochos is a legal-forensic term: guilty-of, liable-to. Real-presence and memorial readings both account for this verse, the former by literal contact with Christ's body, the latter by treating the elements representing the body and blood unworthily.

1Cor.11.29 · complicates · genre: epistle

Key term. ὁ γὰρ ἐσθίων καὶ πίνων κρίμα ἑαυτῷ ἐσθίει καὶ πίνει μὴ διακρίνων τὸ σῶμα; diakrinōn G1252 present active participle nominative masculine singular; sōma G4983 accusative neuter singular; krīma G2917

Force. 'For the one eating and drinking eats and drinks judgment to himself, not discerning the body.' diakrinō ('discern, distinguish') with sōma is the contested phrase. Real-presence reading: failing to recognize the body of Christ in the consecrated bread. Memorial reading: failing to discern the body of Christ which is the church (the Corinthian rich were shaming the poor in vv.21-22; 1 Cor 12 explicates the body-of-Christ-as-church). Both readings are exegetically possible; the local context of vv.21-22 favors the body-as-church reading.

Matt.26.26 · for · genre: gospel · figures: metaphor

Key term. λάβετε φάγετε τοῦτό ἐστιν τὸ σῶμά μου; labete G2983 aorist active imperative 2p; phagete G5315 aorist active imperative 2p; estin G1510 present indicative 3s; sōma G4983

Force. 'Take, eat; this is my body.' Aorist imperatives labete phagete command decisive reception. The estin clause is the lexical hinge: literal identification (real-presence traditions) versus figurative-predicational identification (memorial). Jesus is bodily present at the table while speaking, holding the bread. The figure of speech is parallel to ego eimi hē ampelos ('I am the vine', John 15:1) and other identification-metaphors.

Matt.26.28 · for · genre: gospel · figures: metaphor, metonymy

Key term. τοῦτο γὰρ ἐστιν τὸ αἷμά μου τῆς διαθήκης τὸ περὶ πολλῶν ἐκχυννόμενον εἰς ἄφεσιν ἁμαρτιῶν; haima G129; diathēkē G1242; ekchunnomenon G1632; aphesis G859; hamartia G266

Force. 'For this is my blood of the covenant, which is poured out for many for the forgiveness of sins.' The cup is identified with the covenant-blood; the present-passive ekchunnomenon foregrounds the imminent crucifixion-bloodshed; the purpose clause eis aphesisin hamartiōn ('for the forgiveness of sins') ties the rite to the atoning ground.

Mark.14.22 · for · genre: gospel · figures: metaphor

Key term. λάβετε τοῦτό ἐστιν τὸ σῶμά μου; labete G2983 aorist active imperative 2p; estin G1510

Force. 'Take; this is my body.' Markan parallel to Matt 26:26. Same predicational estin clause, same dominical-institution context. The lexical hinge between literal and figurative readings is identical.

John.6.53 · complicates · genre: gospel · figures: metaphor

Key term. ἐὰν μὴ φάγητε τὴν σάρκα τοῦ υἱοῦ τοῦ ἀνθρώπου καὶ πίνητε αὐτοῦ τὸ αἷμα οὐκ ἔχετε ζωὴν ἐν ἑαυτοῖς; phagēte G5315 aorist active subjunctive 2p; sarx G4561; haima G129; zōē G2222

Force. 'Unless you eat the flesh of the Son of Man and drink his blood, you have no life in yourselves.'
Conditional ean-clause with aorist subjunctive phagēte. Used by every real-presence tradition. Memorial reading takes this figuratively-spiritually based on Jesus's own coda in v.63 (see below).

John.6.54 · complicates · genre: gospel · figures: metaphor

Key term. ὁ τρώγων μου τὴν σάρκα καὶ πίνων μου τὸ αἷμα ἔχει ζωὴν αἰώνιον; trōgō G5176 present active participle nominative masculine singular; aiōnios G166

Force. 'Whoever feeds on my flesh and drinks my blood has eternal life.' trōgō ('feed on, gnaw, munch') is the strongest physical-consumption verb in the discourse. Real-presence traditions take this as decisive for some form of bodily reception of Christ in the eucharist. Memorial reading reads trōgō figuratively for spiritual feeding by faith, controlled by v.63.

John.6.63 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. τὸ πνεῦμά ἐστιν τὸ ζωοποιεῖν ἡ σὰρξ οὐκ ὠφελεῖ οὐδὲν τὰ ῥήματα ἃ ἐγὼ λελάληκα ὑμῖν πνεῦμά ἐστιν καὶ ζωὴ ἐστιν; pneuma G4151; zōopoieō G2227 present active participle; sarx G4561; ophelēō G5623; rhēma G4487

Force. 'It is the Spirit who gives life; the flesh is of no help at all. The words that I have spoken to you are spirit and life.' Jesus's own interpretive coda to the bread-of-life discourse. The contrast pneuma-zōopoiei / sarx ouk ōphelēi strongly suggests the eat-my-flesh language of vv.53-58 must be read at the level of spirit and life, not crude physical consumption. The most-load-bearing single text against a literal-physical reading of John 6.

Heb.10.3 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. ἀλλ' ἐν αὐταῖς ἀνάμνησις ἁμαρτιῶν κατ' ἐνιαυτόν; anamnēsis G364 nominative feminine singular; hamartia G266 genitive feminine plural; eniautos G1763 accusative masculine singular

Force. 'But in those sacrifices there is a reminder of sins every year.' The fourth and only non-Supper NT occurrence of anamnēsis. Levitical sacrifices serve as annual cultic anamnēsis of sins because the blood of bulls and goats cannot remove sins (v.4). Establishes the same word in cultic-memorial register but with a function the Lord's Supper does NOT share: under the New Covenant the Supper recalls the once-for-all sacrifice that HAS removed sin.

Heb.10.10 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. ἡγιασμένοι ἐσμέν διὰ τῆς προσφορᾶς τοῦ σώματος Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ ἐφάπαξ; hagiazō G37 perfect passive participle; prosphora G4376; sōma G4983; ephapax G2178

Force. 'We have been sanctified through the offering of the body of Jesus Christ once for all.' ephapax G2178 ('once for all') is the controlling adverb of the entire Hebrews 10 argument. The offering of Christ's body is non-recurring by definition. This rules out any reading of the Supper as a re-offering, re-presentation, or re-substantiation of the body of Christ.

Heb.10.12 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. οὗτος δὲ μίαν ὑπὲρ ἁμαρτιῶν προσενέγκας θυσίαν εἰς τὸ διηνεκὲς ἐκάθισεν ἐν δεξιᾷ τοῦ θεοῦ; mian G1520; thysia G2378; diēnekēs G1336; kathēmai G2523 aorist active indicative 3s

Force. 'But this one, when he had offered one sacrifice for sins for all time (eis to diēnekēs), sat down at the right hand of God.' One sacrifice, for all time, then seated. The aorist kathisen with diēnekēs drives home the finished-once character of the atoning act. Compare with Levitical priests who 'stand daily ministering and offering the same sacrifices over and over' (v.11) precisely because those could never take sins away.

Heb.10.14 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. μιᾷ γὰρ προσφορᾷ τετελείωκεν εἰς τὸ διηνεκὲς τοὺς ἁγιαζομένους; mia G1520 dative feminine singular; prosphora G4376 dative feminine singular; teleioō G5048 perfect active indicative 3s; diēnekēs G1336; hagiāzomenous G37 present passive participle accusative masculine plural

Force. 'For by one offering he has perfected for all time those who are being sanctified.' Perfect-tense teteleiōken ('has perfected', with abiding result) plus eis to diēnekēs ('for all time') seals the once-for-all character of the atoning act. The Supper recalls a perfected sacrifice; it does not contribute to or complete a sacrifice still in progress.

Heb.9.28 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. οὕτως καὶ ὁ Χριστὸς ἅπαξ προσενηχθεὶς εἰς τὸ πολλῶν ἀνενεγκεῖν ἁμαρτίας; hapax G530; prospherō G4374 aorist passive participle; anapherō G399 aorist active infinitive

Force. 'So Christ, having been offered once (hapax) to bear the sins of many.' hapax G530 ('once') is the parallel to ephapax G2178 ('once for all') in Heb 10:10. The aorist-passive participle prosenechtheis frames the offering as a completed past act. Together with 10:10, 10:12, 10:14 establishes the pan-canonical Hebrews-pattern of one finished offering.

John.10.9 · for · genre: gospel · figures: metaphor

Key term. ἐγὼ εἰμι ἡ θύρα; egō eimi G1473+G1510; thyra G2374

Force. 'I am the door.' Lexical parallel to 'this is my body.' The estin / eimi construction with predicative noun-equation is a Johannine I-am-saying pattern used metaphorically. Jesus is not a wooden plank with hinges. The figure-of-speech grammar of identification-by-predication is well-attested in the same Greek register as Matt 26:26 / Mark 14:22 / Luke 22:19.

John.15.1 · for · genre: gospel · figures: metaphor

Key term. ἐγὼ εἰμι ἡ ἀμπελος ἡ ἀληθινή; ampelos G288; alēthinōs G228

Force. 'I am the true vine.' Another I-am-saying in the same metaphorical-predicational register. Jesus is not literally a plant. Provides additional Johannine-Synoptic concordance support for reading 'this is my body' figuratively rather than substantially.

1Cor.11.21 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. ἕκαστος γὰρ τὸ ἴδιον δεῖπνον προλαμβάνει ἐν τῷ φαγεῖν καὶ ὃς μὲν πεινᾷ ὃς δὲ μεθύει; prolambanō G4301 present active indicative 3s; deipnon G1173; peinaō G3983; methuō G3184

Force. 'For in eating, each one goes ahead with his own meal; one goes hungry while another gets drunk.' Local Corinthian context for vv.27-29. The 'unworthy manner' Paul is rebuking is specifically the rich shaming the poor at the supper-table. This frames the 'discern the body' question in v.29: the body that the Corinthians were failing to discern was the body-as-church, their poor brothers and sisters.

1Cor.12.27 · **for** · genre: epistle · figures: metaphor

Key term. ὑμεῖς δὲ ἐστε σῶμα Χριστοῦ καὶ μέλη ἐκ μέρους; sōma G4983; melos G3196

Force. 'You are the body of Christ and individually members of it.' Paul's own canonical-context usage of sōma in 1 Cor. The body-as-church is the dominant sōma usage in 1 Cor 10-12. Strongly supports reading 'not discerning the body' in 11:29 as failing to discern the church-as-body.

Exod.12.14 · **for** · genre: narrative

Key term. זִכָּרוֹן הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה מִן הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה; zikaron H2146 noun masculine singular construct

Force. 'This day shall be for you a memorial day.' Hebrew zikaron ('memorial') is the Old Covenant analog to anamnēsis. The Passover is instituted as a memorial-meal of the deliverance from Egypt. The Lord's Supper is the New Covenant analog: a recurring memorial-meal of the deliverance from sin through Christ's blood (Luke 22:15-20 places the Supper inside a Passover meal).

Exod.13.9 · **for** · genre: narrative

Key term. זִכָּרוֹן הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה מִן הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה; zikaron H2146

Force. 'It shall be to you a sign on your hand and a memorial between your eyes.' Establishes the OT category of memorial-sign that re-presents the deliverance to the participant. Background grammar for the NT Supper as memorial-sign.

Concordance lemmas traversed

G364, G4160, G3778, G1510, G2605, G1252, G4983, G129, G1242, G2537, G1632, G5176, G5315, G4561, G2222, G4151, G2227, G5623, G4487, G3880, G3860, G5228, G371, G1777, G2917, G2378, G4376, G2178, G530, G5048, G1336, G1520, G37, G2374, G288, G3196, G4301, G1173, G3983, G3184, G266, G1763, G859, G2983, G4374, G399, H2146

complicating texts searched: Yes

Counter-witness traditions

patristic · Ignatius of Antioch, Epistle to the Smyrnaeans 7, ca. AD 110; ccel.org / newadvent.org fetch verified · **complicates** · **verified**

"Heretics abstain from the Eucharist and from prayer, because they confess not the Eucharist to be the flesh of our Saviour Jesus Christ, which suffered for our sins. Strong patristic realist reading."

patristic · Justin Martyr, First Apology 66, ca. AD 155; ccel.org fetch verified · **complicates** · **verified**

"Not as common bread and common drink do we receive these; the food which is blessed by the prayer of His word is the flesh and blood of that Jesus who was made flesh."

catholic_magisterial · Catechism of the Catholic Church 1376; Council of Trent; vatican.va fetch verified · **denies** · **verified**

"By the consecration of the bread and wine there takes place a change of the whole substance of the bread into the substance of the body of Christ and of the whole substance of the wine into the substance of his blood."

lutheran · Augsburg Confession Article X; Formula of Concord Article VII; bookofconcord.org (502 on fetch attempts) · **denies** · **unverified**

"The body and blood of Christ are truly present and are distributed to those who eat in the Supper of the Lord. The body and blood are truly and substantially present in, with, and under the bread and wine."

anglican · 39 Articles of Religion, Article 28 (Of the Lord's Supper); anglicansonline.org
fetch verified · affirms · verified

“Transubstantiation in the Supper of the Lord cannot be proved by Holy Writ; the Body of Christ is given, taken, and eaten in the Supper only after a heavenly and spiritual manner, and the mean is Faith.”

**reformed · Westminster Confession of Faith Chapter 29; Calvin Institutes IV.17;
Heidelberg Catechism Q75-82 · affirms · unverified**

“Worthy receivers really and indeed, yet not carnally and corporally, but spiritually, receive and feed upon Christ crucified and all the benefits of his death. Rejects transubstantiation as repugnant to Scripture and reason.”

**methodist · Wesley, Hymns on the Lord's Supper 1745 with Daniel Brevint preface; UMC
This Holy Mystery doctrinal statement · complicates · unverified**

“Wesleyan tradition affirms real spiritual presence and rejects memorial-only as too thin. The Supper is a means of grace by which Christ is truly conveyed to the receiving believer.”

anabaptist · Schleithem Confession 1527, Article III; courses.washington.edu
fetch verified · affirms · verified

“All those who wish to break one bread in remembrance of the broken body of Christ and all who wish to drink of one drink as a remembrance of the shed blood of Christ. Memorial-remembrance frame.”

**pentecostal · Assemblies of God Statement of Fundamental Truths Article 6 (The
Ordinances of the Church); ag.org**
fetch returned 403 · affirms · unverified

“The Lord's Supper is a symbol expressing our sharing the divine nature of our Lord Jesus Christ, a memorial of his suffering and death, and a prophecy of his second coming. Memorialist position.”

eastern_orthodox · Orthodox Church in America, on the Eucharist; oca.org
fetch verified · denies · verified

“The eucharist contains the genuine Body and Blood of Christ; Orthodoxy preserves the mystery itself, refusing rationalistic explanations like transubstantiation while affirming real presence.”

Web sources

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/luke/22-19.htm>

“Luke 22:19: touto poieite eis tēn emēn anamnēsin. G364 anamnēsis: active deliberate recollection / memorial. G4160 poieite present imperative: keep doing.”

supports · category: interlinear · https://biblehub.com/interlinear/1_corinthians/11-24.htm

“1 Cor 11:24: touto mou estin to sōma to hyper hymōn; touto poieite eis tēn emēn anamnēsin. Same anamnēsis-eis-purpose construction as Luke 22:19.”

supports · category: interlinear · https://biblehub.com/interlinear/1_corinthians/11-26.htm

“1 Cor 11:26: ton thanaton tou kyriou katangellete achri hou elthē. G2605 katangellō: proclaim, announce publicly. The Supper is publicly-declarative until Christ returns.”

complicates · category: interlinear · https://biblehub.com/interlinear/1_corinthians/11-29.htm

“1 Cor 11:29: mē diakrinōn to sōma. G1252 diakrinō: distinguish, discriminate. The contested phrase; local context 11:21-22 favors body-as-church reading.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/greek/364.htm>

“G364 anamnēsis: 4 NT occurrences total. Luke 22:19, 1 Cor 11:24, 1 Cor 11:25 (institution), Heb 10:3 (annual reminder of sins under old covenant).”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/hebrews/10-10.htm>

“Heb 10:10: hēgiasmenoi esmen dia tēs prosphoras tou sōmatos Iēsou Christou ephapax. G2178 ephapax once-for-all. Rules out re-offering.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/john/6-63.htm>

“John 6:63: to pneuma estin to zōopoion, hē sarx ouk ōphelei ouden. Jesus's interpretive coda to the bread-of-life discourse. Spirit and life, not crude flesh-eating.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/luke/22-20.htm>

“Luke 22:20: touto to potērion hē kainē diathēkē en tō haimati mou. G1242 diathēkē new covenant, G1632 ekchunnomenon poured out, in figure-of-speech identification.”

complicates · category: patristic_archive · <https://ccel.org/ccel/schaff/anf01/anf01.viii.ii.lxvi.html>

“Justin Martyr First Apology 66: not as common bread and common drink do we receive these; the food which is blessed is the flesh and blood of that Jesus who was made flesh.”

complicates · category: patristic_archive · <https://www.newadvent.org/fathers/0109.htm>

“Ignatius Smyrnaeans 7: heretics abstain from the Eucharist because they confess not the Eucharist to be the flesh of our Saviour Jesus Christ, which suffered for our sins.”

opposes · category: magisterial · https://www.vatican.va/archive/ENG0015/___P41.HTM

“CCC 1376: by the consecration of the bread and wine there takes place a change of the whole substance of the bread into the substance of the body of Christ. Catholic transubstantiation.”

supports · category: tradition_primary · https://anglicansonline.org/basics/thirty-nine_articles.html

“39 Articles 28: Transubstantiation cannot be proved by Holy Writ; is repugnant to the plain words of Scripture. Body of Christ given and eaten only after heavenly and spiritual manner; mean is Faith.”

opposes · category: tradition_primary · <https://oca.org/orthodoxy/the-orthodox-faith/worship/the-sacraments/holy-eucharist>

“Orthodox affirm genuine Body and Blood of Christ while refusing rationalistic explanations like transubstantiation. Eucharist is mystery of the Kingdom resisting rational analysis.”

supports · category: tradition_primary · <https://courses.washington.edu/hist112/SCHLEITHEIM%20CONFESSION%20OF%20FAITH.htm>

“Schleitheim Confession 1527 Article III: all those who wish to break one bread in remembrance of the broken body of Christ and drink one drink as a remembrance of the shed blood of Christ.”

Flags

- stem-pre-loaded-verdict
- apparatus-vs-counter-witness-conflict
- confession-tradition-divergence